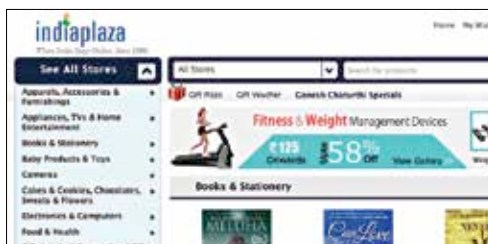


Since its introduction, the company has grown and evolved. Shortly after their introduction, Indiaplaza was re-branded as Fabmall. The business then also restructured into two separate online and offline entities and Fabmall.com once again became Indiaplaza – this time with a difference. In 2007, two distinct India-centric websites were launched with indiaplaza.com created to serve customers in the US and indiaplaza.in being created to serve customers in India. However, as e-commerce has grown and the world has become a smaller place, in 2011, Indiaplaza introduced a common single website to serve customers worldwide.

Today, Indiaplaza offers over 10 million items online for sale across books, music, videos, CD-ROMs, electronics, camera, mobile phones, appliances, apparel, flowers, chocolates, cakes, sweets toys, watches, food items etc. – you name it, they probably have it. With nearly 1.5 million customers worldwide, Indiaplaza is the most popular destination for Indians outside India to send gifts to their friends and relatives living in India.



Indiaplaza is as old as the ecommerce industry in India. However, even after successfully concluding private equity funding in 2011, K Vaitheeswaran, founder and CEO of Indiaplaza feels that the e-commerce industry in India has all the makings of a perverse fight as flush with cash from venture capital, online retailers in India today are pursuing a single-minded strategy of acquiring as many customers as they can by cutting prices and aiming solely for topline growth without any thought of making money. Growth has taken precedence over profitability – the key tenet of any business. Think about it. Today, if online retailer is cutting into their 35% margin to offer you a 40% discount and also offers shipping for free – how long can this model be sustainable?

E-Commerce in India: The long journey of evolution

The Indian e-commerce industry has come a long way since its humble beginnings some years ago. Then, online transactions were predominantly